Tamar (Tamri) Matiashvili

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Stanford University 2021–
M.A. in Economics, Stanford University 2024
B.A. in Economics and Psychology, Middlebury College 2018
Summa Cum Laude, College Scholar, Highest Honors in Economics, Phi Beta Kappa (Junior year)

References

Ran Abramitzky
SFCU Professor of Economics
Dept. of Economics, Stanford University
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Petra Persson
Associate Professor of Economics
Dept. of Economics, Stanford University
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Maria Polyakova
Associate Professor of Health Policy
School of Medicine, Stanford University
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Alessandra Voena
Professor of Economics
Dept. of Economics, Stanford University
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Research Fields

Primary fields: Economic History, Labor Economics
Secondary fields: Health Economics, Gender Economics

Published & Forthcoming Research Papers

"Culture, Economic Stress, and Missing Girls" with Viktor Malein and Francisco Beltrán Tapia. *Accepted at the* ***Journal of Economic History***.

"Intergenerational Mobility over Two Centuries" with Ran Abramitzky and Leah Boustan. Forthcoming, ***Handbook of Intergenerational Mobility***.

"Modernization in Progress: Part-Year Operation, Capital Accumulation, and Labor Force Composition in Late Imperial Russia" with Amanda Gregg. ***Journal of Economic History***, 2022, 82(4), 1143–1182.
Runner-up: Arthur H. Cole Prize in Journal of Economic History for the best article in the previous year's volume.

Working Papers

"Talent, Trust, and Health: The Effects of the First Female Physicians." *(JMP)*

*2nd Place Winner of the Stanford Inaugural 3MT Thesis Competition, **Video**.*

How does removing barriers to entry for previously excluded groups affect productivity in high-skill professions? Using the entry of the first female physicians into the Russian Empire's rural healthcare system and a staggered difference-in-differences design, I find that female physician entry reduced infant and young-adult mortality and increased life expectancy. Evidence on healthcare use and physician value added suggests two complementary mechanisms: greater physician effectiveness due to positive selection among early female entrants and increased use of formal medical care by women.

"Worth the Wait? Willingness to Pay for Gender-Concordant Physicians Across Medical Specialties" with Helen Kissel and Helena Roy.

Using a randomized choice experiment that mirrors online physician-search platforms, we study patient preferences for physician gender across medical specialties. Women prefer female physicians in gender-sensitive specialties, but not neutral ones, with stronger preferences among women reporting prior negative gender-related healthcare experiences. Men exhibit no significant gender-concordance preferences. Using Medicare claims data, we show that female bladder cancer patients are more likely to see female urologists and wait longer when doing so, while male patients show no similar patterns, suggesting that physician-gender preferences affect provider choice and the timing of care.

"Cultural Links and Technology Diffusion: Evidence from Industry in Late Imperial Russia" with Timur Natkhov.

This paper examines the impact of ethnic connections on the diffusion of technology in a late-industrializing economy. Using machine learning, we assigned probable ethnicities to nearly 16,000 industrial firm owners in the Russian Empire in 1894. We then compared firms owned by entrepreneurs with cultural connections to Europe to Russian-owned firms. "Connected" firms exhibited higher productivity, employed modern machinery and advanced management practices. We established the knowledge diffusion channel by showing, among others, that "connected" firms traded more with Europe, and that German-origin entrepreneurs had the largest productivity advantage in chemicals – Germany's leading industry at the time.

"Paid Caregiving Leave Policies and an Update on Paid Parental Leave" with Priyanka Anand and Maya Rossin-Slater, in preparation for the *Oxford Handbook on the Economics of Care.*

Works in Progress

"Physician Value Added in the Pre-Antibiotic Era"

"Technology Transfers and Industrial Productivity: Evidence from Postwar Germany and the Soviet Union" with Michela Giorcelli

"Willingness to Wait for Racially Concordant Physicians" with Helen Kissel and Helena Roy.

"Improvements in Urban Sanitation and Child Mortality Decline: The Case of the Russian Empire" with Viktor Malein.

"The Patenting System of the Russian Empire", in preparation for *International Historical Patent Data and Institutions.*

Awards, Honors, & Fellowships

Leonard W. Ely and Shirley R. Ely Graduate Student Fellowship	2026
Stanford Inaugural 3MT Thesis Competition, 2nd Place	2025
Economic History Association Graduate (EHA) Fellowship	2025
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Stanford Economics Department	2024
Gerhard Casper Fellow, Stanford Graduate Fellowship	2021–
Frederick C. Dirks Award for excellence and high promise in the field of economics (Middlebury)	2018
Christian A. Johnson Award for graduating with the highest GPA in economics (Middlebury)	2018
Middlebury Summer Internship Grant	2017

Research Grants

Institute for Humane Studies Grant	2026
Stanford Graduate Research Opportunity Grant	2026
Stanford King Center on Global Development, Exploratory Grant	2024
George P. Shultz Dissertation Fellowship (Stanford SIEPR)	2024
Diversity Dissertation Research Opportunity (Stanford VPGE)	2024
The Europe Center Graduate Student Grant (Stanford FSI)	2024
EHA Early Stage Dissertation Grant	2024
Stanford King Center on Global Development, Travel Grant	2023

Invited Seminars & Workshops

Northwestern Economic History Seminar	2026
Yale Economic History Lunch; University of San Francisco Seminar; Stanford History of Capitalism & Gender History Joint Workshop (History Department)	2025
LMU Munich Economic History Workshop; Middlebury College Faculty Brownbag	2024
University of Helsinki Economic History Seminar*	2023

* *indicates non-JMP presentations*

Talks at Conferences

UCLA Econ. Hist.; EHA; All-Cal. Labor Econ.; SITE (Econ. of Health Inequality)*; SITE (Gender); WEAI Grad. Stud. Workshop; Cliometrics (CLIO); SOLE	2026
ASSA (discuss.)*; WEAI*; EHA (discuss.)*	2025
Asia Pacific Econ. and Busin. Hist.*; ASREC*; CLIO*; SIOE*; EHA (poster)	2024
Summer Workshop in the Econ. Hist. and Hist. Polit. Econ. of Eurasia*; ASREC Europe*	2023
Williams College Women in Economic Research Undergraduate Conference*	2018

* *indicates non-JMP presentations*

Teaching and Course Experience

Teaching Assistant for Christine Pal Chee, PUBLPOL 105/205, Empirical Methods in Public Policy — 2025, 2026
Course Assistant for Alessandra Voena, ECON 101, Economic Policy Seminar — 2025
Teaching Assistant for Megha Patnaik, ECON 109, Economics from Outer Space — 2024

Invited Lectures

Topics in Economic History (Graduate Class, Stanford Economics) — 2025, 2026
Big Brain SF, Lecture "How Women Changed the Workforce" — 2025

Service

Refereeing: *Quarterly Journal of Economics; European Review of Economic History; Economic History Research*

Other

Ran Abramitzky's advising group (20+ students), Organizer — 2024-2026
Bay Area Student Economic History Workshop, Organizer — 2024

Academic Employment History

Research Assistant to Professors Maya Rossin-Slater and Priyanka Anand — 2025
Research Assistant to Professor Michela Giorcelli, UCLA/NBER — 2024
Research Assistant to Professor Ran Abramitzky, Stanford University — 2023
Research Assistant to Professors Heidi Williams and Daniel Fetter, NBER — 2018–2021
Research Assistant to Professor Amanda Gregg, Middlebury College — 2016–2018
Research Assistant to Professors Frank Keil and Samuel Johnson (psychology), Yale University Cognition and Development Lab — 2017

Other

Languages: Georgian (Native), English (Fluent), Russian (Fluent), German (Advanced), French (Intermediate)
Technical: Stata, R, Python, Julia
Citizenship: Georgia; US Permanent Resident